

Emerging IT careers

Research one with dated evidence.

College and Career Exploration · Week 3 · Day 4

Bring your Chromebook and your Major 1 packet. No workbook today.

As you enter

Name one technology you use today that did NOT exist when your parents were in middle school.

Say it like this

_____ did not exist then. Somebody had to _____ it, so a new job appeared:
_____.

Smartphones, video calls, streaming, AI chatbots. Two people share.

Today you will

- 1 Learn what 'emerging' means and the exact-or-proxy rule.
- 2 Choose one of six changing IT careers.
- 3 Research it with the dated evidence guide: tasks, preparation, median pay, growth, and the date of every number.
- 4 Compare it to a traditional IT career on the exit ticket.

Word of the day: proxy. A broader job used to stand in when your exact job title is not listed.

Exact match or proxy?

The Bureau of Labor Statistics does not list every new job title

Data Scientists PRINTER-FRIENDLY

Summary What They Do Work Environment How to Become One Pay Job Outlook State & Area Data Similar Occupations More Info

Summary

Quick Facts: Data Scientists	
2025 Median Pay ?	\$120,230 per year \$57.80 per hour
Typical Entry-Level Education ?	Bachelor's degree
Work Experience in a Related Occupation ?	None
On-the-job Training ?	None
Number of Jobs, 2025 ?	275,600
Job Outlook, 2025-35 ?	35% (Much faster than average)
Employment Change, 2025-35 ?	95,400



A BLS Quick Facts box. Every number has a year next to it. Copy the year every time.

Emerging means the work is new or changing fast because of new technology. A new-sounding name by itself is not evidence.

Exact

BLS lists your job by name. Data Scientist is exact.

Proxy

BLS lists a broader job that includes yours. Cloud Architect uses Computer Network Architects.

None

A cool job title with no BLS page is not proof the job is new. It is a missing source.

Choose one career

Emerging IT Career Evidence Guide · link on the Day 4 page

AI / Machine Learning Engineer

BLS label: proxy

Cloud Architect

BLS label: proxy

Information Security Analyst

BLS label: exact

Data Scientist

BLS label: exact

UX Designer

BLS label: closest match

Drone Software Developer

BLS label: proxy

[Open the dated Emerging IT Career Evidence Guide](#)

The guide carries the BLS occupation, the page link, and the dated numbers for each. Take the choice you can explain in one sentence.

Research with dated evidence

30 minutes · Voice 0 · Open the Emerging Tech Research Template

Open the Emerging Tech Research Template

- 1 Copy the BLS occupation and its label (exact or proxy) from the guide.
- 2 Open the BLS page from the guide. Record tasks, preparation, median pay, growth.
- 3 Write the YEAR next to every number. Guide and website disagree? Use the newer one and say so.
- 4 Explain in two sentences why this work is new or changing.

Check yourself

Minute 10: occupation and label written.

Minute 22: the 'why it is changing' sentences started.

You are done when

every number has a year, the label matches the guide, and your two sentences name a technology.

Finished early? Open the Similar Occupations tab on your BLS page and record one job that could be a second proxy.

Turn and tell

60 seconds each · Voice 1

Tell your partner which career you chose and whether your evidence is exact or a proxy. Your partner repeats it back in one sentence.

Say it like this

BLS reports this exact career.

BLS reports a related occupation that helps us understand this career.

Words you will need

occupation · task · preparation · median pay · growth · exact match · proxy

Exit ticket: emerging vs. traditional

Open the Emerging/Established IT Career Comparison · 7 minutes

Open the Emerging/Established IT Career Comparison

Your emerging career vs. one traditional IT career (Software Developer, Web Developer, Network Administrator, or Database Administrator).

Rows: what they do · median salary (BLS, with year) · growth rate (BLS, with years) · why did this career exist 20 years ago?

Bottom line

Which of the two is growing faster right now? Use the growth rates from your matrix to back it up in one sentence.

Say it like this

_____ is growing faster: _____% vs. _____% (BLS, _____).

Before you go

- 1 Research template finished, every number dated.
- 2 Comparison submitted and added to your Major 1 packet.
- 3 Packet turned in: plan, four screens, partner notes, starred changes, evidence sheet.

Tomorrow is Xello: a quiz about how you learn, then a short lesson. No packet needed.